

TOOTHY ARRAY

HETERODONTOSAURUS

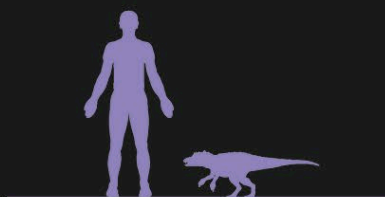
The unusual, turkey-sized *Heterodontosaurus* has confused scientists since it was discovered in 1962. Unlike the uniform teeth of most reptiles, *Heterodontosaurus* had striking, different-shaped teeth lining its jaws—an arrangement known as “heterodonty”—from which this dinosaur gets its name. This pattern of teeth resembles that of modern-day mammals and has led paleontologists to believe that *Heterodontosaurus* had a varied diet—eating anything from small animals and insects to hard-to-chew plants. Paleontologists think its toothless beak, as well as its long, strong arms and three grasping fingers, may have helped *Heterodontosaurus* grab its food.

SPECIAL TEETH

Heterodontosaurus's jaws housed three different types of teeth. The upper jaw had a pair of sharp tusks, while two unusually long teeth sat on the lower jaw. *Heterodontosaurus* also had short, cone-shaped front teeth and broad cheek teeth, which would have helped it grind up tough plant matter.

AT A GLANCE

- **LENGTH** 3 ft (1 m)
- **DIET** Omnivore
- **LIVED** 200–190 MYA
- **HABITAT** Shrublands



STATS AND FACTS

20 IN
(51 CM)
MAXIMUM HEIGHT

Heterodontosaurus is known from some exquisitely preserved adult specimens, as well as some rare fossils of youngsters. As a result, we know quite a lot of detail about its lifestyle compared to some others from the Early Jurassic Period.

SPEED



Heterodontosaurus moved around on its hind legs and could reach speeds of more than 2½ mph (4 kph).

WEIGHT



Adults would have weighed around 22 lb (10 kg), with youngsters probably weighing around 4 lb (2 kg).